

Higher order derivatives

We can take partial derivatives of partial derivatives and then we call 2^{nd} order partial derivatives

e.g. $f(x, y) = x^2y + e^{x+y}$

compute 2^{nd} order partial derivatives

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(x, y) = 2xy + e^{x+y}$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(x, y) = x^2 + e^{x+y}$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right) (x, y) = 2y + e^{x+y}$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial y} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right) (x, y) = e^{x+y}$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial y} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right) (x, y) = 2x + e^{x+y}$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right) (x, y) = 2x + e^{x+y}$$

these are called crossed or mixed
 2^{nd} order partial derivatives

Thm: if $f \in C^2$ (all 2^{nd} order part. der. are continuous)
then $\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y \partial x} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y}$.

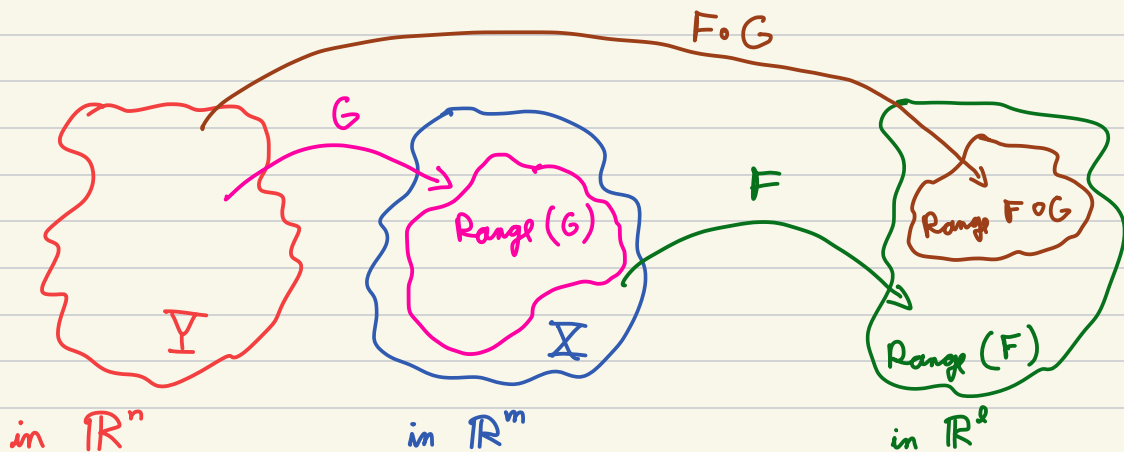
e.g. Verify that $f(x, y, z) = 2x^2 - y^2 - z^2$
satisfies $\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial z^2} = 0$.

The Chain Rule

February 23, 2026

Recall from Calc I : If $g: Y \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and $f: X \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$
 both f and g differentiable and such that $\text{Range}(g) \subseteq X$,
 then $f \circ g: Y \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is differentiable and
 $(f \circ g)'(t) = f'(g(t)) \cdot g'(t)$

$$\left(\begin{array}{l} \text{we can also think of it as } g: Y \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \quad f: X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ t \mapsto g(t) = x(t) \quad x \mapsto (x) \\ \frac{d}{dt}(f \circ g)(t) = \frac{df}{dx} \Big|_{g(t)} \cdot \frac{dg}{dt}(t) = \frac{df}{dx} \frac{dx}{dt} \end{array} \right)$$



Chain rule: Suppose $G: Y \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$
 and $F: X \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^l$
 with $Y \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ open, $X \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m$ open and $\text{Range}(G) \subseteq X$.
 If G is differentiable at $\vec{a}$ and F is differentiable at $G(\vec{a})$,
 then $F \circ G$ is differentiable at $\vec{a}$ and

$$D(F \circ G)|_{\vec{a}} = DF|_{G(\vec{a})} \cdot DG|_{\vec{a}}$$

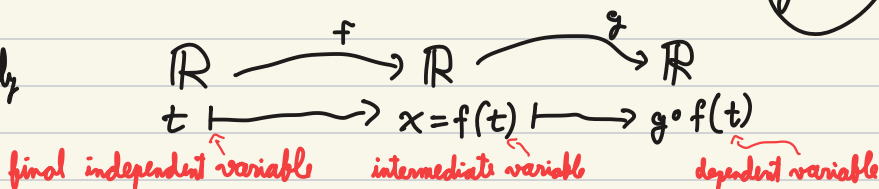
matrix multiplication

e.g.: $g(x) = e^{2x}$

and $f(t) = t^2 - 1 = x(t)$

$(g \circ f)$

pictorially



$$\frac{d}{dt}(g(f(t))) = \frac{dg}{dx} \frac{dx}{dt}$$

$$\frac{dg}{dx} = 2e^{2x}$$

$$\frac{df}{dt} = \frac{dx}{dt} = 2t$$

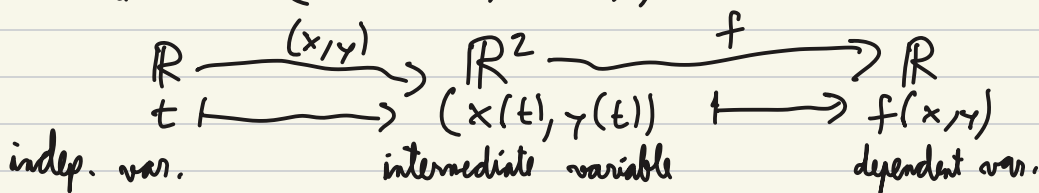
$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dt}(g(f(t))) &= 2e^{2(f(t))} \cdot 2t = 2e^{2t^2-2} \cdot 2t \\ &= 4te^{2t^2-2} \end{aligned}$$

eg: $f(x, y) = e^{2x+y}$

$x = t + 1$

$y = 3t - 4$

$$\frac{df}{dt} = D(F(x(t), y(t)))$$



long path $f(x(t), y(t)) = e^{2(t+1)+3t-4} = e^{5t-2}$ $\frac{df}{dt} = 5e^{5t-2}$

chain rule : $Df|_{(x(t), y(t))} \cdot D(x(t), y(t))|_t$

$Df = \vec{\nabla} f = (2e^{2x+y}, e^{2x+y})$ $D(x, y)|_t = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$

$= (2e^{2(t+1)+(3t-4)}, e^{2(t+1)+(3t-4)}) \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} = 5e^{5t-2}$

$$\text{eg: } F(x, y) = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ x^2 + y \\ 7 \\ \cos(y) \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{recall } DF \in M_{4 \times 2} \\ DG \in M_{2 \times 3}$$

$$G(u, v, w) = \begin{pmatrix} u \\ 2v - w^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$D(F \circ G)$$

||

$$DF|_{G(u, v, w)} \cdot DG|_{(u, v, w)}$$

$$DF|_{(x, y)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2x & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\sin(y) \end{pmatrix}$$

$$DG|_{(u, v, w)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -2w \end{pmatrix}$$

$$D(F \circ G)|_{(u, v, w)} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2x & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\sin(y) \end{pmatrix} \Big|_{G(u, v, w)} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -2w \end{pmatrix}$$

"aside we have"

$$x = u$$

$$y = 2v - w^2$$

$$F \circ G(u, v, w)$$

$$= F(x(u, v, w), y(u, v, w))$$

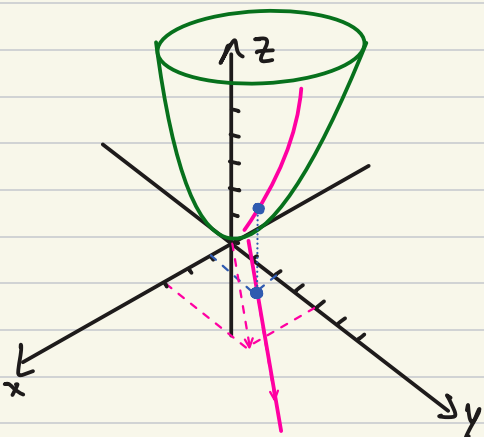
$$\hookrightarrow = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2u & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\sin(2v - w^2) \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & -2w \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 2x & 2 & -2w \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2\sin(2v - w^2) & 2w\sin(2v - w^2) \end{pmatrix}$$

e.g. $f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$

$$x(t) = 3t + 1$$

$$y(t) = 4t + 2$$



$$D(f(x(t), y(t)))$$

$$Df = (2x \quad 2y)$$

$$D(x, y) = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

evaluate at $t = 0$

$$D(f \circ (x, y)(t)) = (2(1) \quad 2(2)) \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= 6 + 16 = 22$$

$$\frac{df}{dt} = 22$$

speed of $(x(t), y(t))$ motion at $t = 0$
 $s = \sqrt{3^2 + 4^2}$

normalizing $\frac{df}{dt}$ by the speed we get $\frac{22}{s}$

$$\vec{\nabla} f|_{(1,2)} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 3/5 \\ 4/5 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{22}{5}$$

derivative of f as we pass the point $(1, 2)$
 with velocity in the direction $(3, 4)$ and speed 1 is $\frac{22}{5}$